

Ch 5: Print Culture and the Modern World

Question Bank | 2M | 3M | 5M

SECTION A — 2 MARKS

Q1. Who published 'Samvad Kaumudi'? What was its significance? (PYQ 2024)

Q2. What is meant by 'calligraphy'? In which countries was it practised before the printing press?

Q3. Buddhist missionaries from China introduced hand printing technology into which country around AD 768–770? (PYQ 2020)

Q4. What was the first book printed by Gutenberg? How many copies were printed? (PYQ 2018)

Q5. Who brought the first printing press to India? (PYQ 2020)

Q6. Which aspects were common among the writings of Kailashbashini Debi, Tarabai Shinde and Pandita Ramabai? (PYQ 2023)

Q7. What is meant by 'Vellum'? What was it used for before the printing press?

Q8. What is meant by 'Platen' in the context of early printing technology?

Q9. What was the 'Diamond Sutra'? Why is it significant in the history of print?

Q10. What was the Vernacular Press Act of 1878? Who passed it and why?

Q11. Who was Johann Gutenberg? What was his contribution to the history of print?

Q12. What is meant by the 'Print Revolution'? How did it change people's relationship with information?

Q13. What were 'Penny Magazines'? Why were they published?

Q14. Who was James Augustus Hickey? What newspaper did he publish in India?

Q15. What was the 'Index of Prohibited Books'? Who maintained it and why?

Q16. Who was Martin Luther? How did print help spread his ideas? (PYQ 2021)

Q17. What was the 'Erasmus' view on print culture? Why was he critical of it?

Q18. What is meant by 'Chapbooks'? What role did they play in spreading literacy among common people?

Q19. Who was Menocchio? What happened to him because of his ideas spread through print?

Q20. What was 'Accordion Book'? Why was it used in China?

Q21. What was the role of Raja Rammohan Roy in promoting print culture in India?

Q22. Name the book written by Rousseau that was widely circulated through print culture. (PYQ 2019)

Q23. What was the 'oral culture' versus 'reading culture' distinction in Europe before the print revolution?

Q24. What was the 'Bombay Samachar'? What was its significance?

Q25. Who wrote 'Chhote Aur Bade Ka Sawal'? What was its theme?

Q26. What were 'Tracts'? How were they used during the Reformation period?

Q27. What were the fears of authorities regarding print culture? Give two points. (PYQ 2021)

Q28. What was 'Sacchi Kavitayan'? Who compiled it and why was it significant?

Q29. Name any two women writers of 19th century India who used print to express women's experiences. What did they write about?

Q30. What was the 'Protestant Reformation'? How was it linked to the printing press?

SECTION B — 3 MARKS

Q1. "The shift from hand printing to mechanical printing led to the print revolution in Europe." Explain the statement with examples. (PYQ 2023)

Q2. Explain how print culture helped in the spread of the Protestant Reformation in Europe. (PYQ 2021)

Q3. Why did people fear the effect of print? Mention any three reasons. (PYQ 2021)

Q4. How had the Imperial State in China been the major producer of printed material for a long time? (PYQ 2019)

Q5. Explain how print culture affected women in India. What was the attitude of conservatives towards women's literacy? (PYQ)

Q6. Why was the Vernacular Press Act passed in 1878? What did it aim to do?

Q7. How had the printing press created a new culture of reading in Europe? Explain with examples. (PYQ 2019)

Q8. How did novels become easily available to the masses in Europe during the 19th century? Explain three ways. (PYQ 2019)

Q9. Explain how print culture gave the poor in India access to knowledge and self-expression. Give three examples.

Q10. How did print help spread nationalism in India? Explain with reference to newspapers and journals.

Q11. Describe the role of woodblock printing in China and Japan before the advent of the printing press.

Q12. How did the printing press contribute to the spread of science and scientific thinking in Europe? Give examples.

Q13. Explain how print culture created religious debates and conflicts in Europe during the 16th century.

Q14. How did the serialised novel become popular in the 19th century? What role did newspapers play?

Q15. Describe the role of women writers in 19th century India in using print to challenge social norms.

Q16. Why did some people in India fear that print culture would harm social order? Give three points.

Q17. How did lending libraries help spread reading culture among the middle and lower classes in 19th century Europe and India?

Q18. Describe the impact of print on the poor and workers in colonial India. Give examples from Kanpur and Bangalore.

Q19. How did the British use print to strengthen their rule in India? Explain with examples of official publications and censorship.

Q20. Explain how print culture contributed to the French Revolution. Mention three specific ways.

Q21. How did the reading habit spread among women in India in the 19th century? Explain with reference to liberal and conservative families.

Q22. What was the importance of the 'Diamond Sutra' in the history of print? Explain the early printing tradition in East Asia.

Q23. Explain the role of ballads and folk tales in expanding the reading public in Europe after the print revolution.

Q24. How did newspapers and pamphlets help spread reform ideas in 19th century India? Give three examples.

Q25. Explain the significance of Gutenberg's printing press. How was it different from earlier methods of printing?

Q26. How did print culture lead to religious controversies and the Catholic Church's response to it? Explain with examples.

Q27. Describe the role of print in spreading the ideas of the Enlightenment thinkers like Voltaire and Rousseau in Europe.

Q28. How did the arrival of print in India change the nature of religious debate? Explain with examples from Hindu and Muslim communities.

Q29. Why were children and workers considered an important new audience for print culture in colonial India? Explain.

Q30. Explain how the serialisation of novels in newspapers increased their readership. Give two Indian and one European example.

Q31. Why was print considered a threat by colonial authorities in India? How did they try to control it?

Q32. How did print culture help social reformers in India challenge the caste system? Give three examples.

Q33. Describe the development of printing technology from woodblock printing in China to Gutenberg's movable type press in Europe.

Q34. How did printing become a tool for both reform and resistance in 19th century India?

Q35. Explain the role of the 'oral culture' in Europe before print, and how the print revolution slowly replaced it.

Q36. How did print culture contribute to the growth of a 'public sphere' in Europe during the 18th century?

Q37. What was the role of Raja Rammohan Roy's publications in shaping social reform debates in 19th century India?

Q38. Why was print initially available only to elites in Europe? How did this change over time? Explain three reasons.

Q39. Explain how James Augustus Hickey's Bengal Gazette influenced the development of print culture in colonial India.

Q40. How did print help in the unification of different language communities around a common printed language? Give examples from Germany and France.

Q41. Describe the contribution of Jyotiba Phule in using print to challenge caste discrimination in Maharashtra.

Q42. Explain the significance of reading rooms and libraries set up by Indian workers in the early 20th century.

Q43. How did the availability of cheap books through print culture transform education in 19th century India?

Q44. Describe the 'horror of print' felt by religious authorities in both Europe and India. How did they respond?

Q45. Explain how Hindi, Urdu, and Tamil print cultures developed in India and contributed to regional nationalist identities.

SECTION C — 5 MARKS

Q1. Explain the role of print culture in creating the conditions for the French Revolution. (PYQ — *high expected*)

Q2. "The shift from hand printing to mechanical printing led to the print revolution in Europe." Justify the statement with five examples. (PYQ 2023)

Q3. How had the Imperial State in China been the major producer of printed material for a long time? Explain the development of print culture in East Asia. (PYQ 2019)

Q4. How had the printing press created a new culture of reading in Europe? Explain with five examples. (PYQ 2019)

Q5. Trace the development of print technology from its beginnings in East Asia to Gutenberg's press in Europe. (High expected 2025)

Q6. Explain how print culture affected women in India. Describe the attitude of conservatives and the response of women through writing. (PYQ 2013)

Q7. How did print help spread the Protestant Reformation and create religious debates in Europe? Explain with reference to Martin Luther and Menocchio. (PYQ 2021)

Q8. Describe the various measures taken by the British government to censor the vernacular press in India after the Revolt of 1857. (High expected)

Q9. "Print did not directly shape minds, but it did open up the possibility of thinking differently." Justify this statement with five relevant examples.

Q10. Analyse the impact of print on the poor, workers, and low-caste communities in colonial India. How did print become a tool of resistance? (PYQ 2013)

Q11. Describe the role of newspapers and journals in shaping Indian public opinion during the freedom struggle. Give five examples.

Q12. How did the serialised novel and cheap books transform reading habits in Europe and India during the 19th century? Explain with examples.

Q13. Explain how print culture shaped religious debates in India. How did both Hindu reformers and conservative groups use print for their own purposes?

Q14. How did print culture contribute to the spread of nationalist ideas in India? Trace the journey from early newspapers to political journals.

Q15. "The printing press created a reading revolution in Europe." Describe the social, political, and religious impact of this revolution with five points.

Q16. How did novels become a powerful medium to express social realities in 19th century India? Give examples from different regional languages.

Q17. Explain how printing technology developed from woodblock printing to Gutenberg's movable type press. What was the impact of this shift on European society?

Q18. How did print culture both help and threaten the existing social and religious order in Europe? Explain the response of the Church and ruling authorities.

Q19. "Print culture gave voice to women, workers, and lower castes who had previously been silenced." Justify this statement with five examples from India.

Q20. How did the Vernacular Press Act of 1878 attempt to suppress Indian nationalist press? What was its impact on Indian journalism and the freedom movement?

Q21. Describe the role of print in creating a new sense of community and national identity in Europe. How did print help standardise languages?

Q22. How did the printing press become connected with the ideas of the Enlightenment? Explain with reference to Voltaire, Rousseau, and other thinkers.

Q23. Trace the history of print culture in India from the arrival of the Portuguese printing press to the growth of the nationalist press in the 20th century.

Q24. How did print culture give rise to new kinds of literature — novels, pamphlets, newspapers — in Europe? Explain the social significance of each.

Q25. "Censorship of print by both colonial and religious authorities showed how powerful the printed word had become." Justify this statement with five examples from Europe and India.

